

Personal life and education

Oscar, the eldest of eight Calderon siblings, was born in [Aliaga, Nueva Ecija](#), on October 1, 1951.^[2] At the time of his appointment by then President [Gloria Macapagal-Arroyo](#) as chief of the [Philippine National Police](#) (PNP), Calderon admitted in a radio interview that he was a "distant relative" of the latter.^[3] Shortly before his appointment, his younger brother, Comm. Leonard Calderon, became deputy chief of the Intelligence Service of the [Armed Forces of the Philippines](#).^{[2][3]}

Calderon was a member of [Philippine Military Academy](#) (PMA) class of 1973.^{[1][2][3]}

While in duty in [Mindanao](#), he later married Ma. Theresa Larrabaster, a local beauty pageant titlist from [General Santos](#). They had at least three children.^[2]

Calderon died on March 8, 2025, at the age of 73. He was later interred at the Heritage Park in [Taguig](#).^[4]

Career

Early years

After graduation from the PMA, he became a junior officer of the then [Philippine Constabulary–Integrated National Police](#) (PC–INP).^[2]

He spent most of his career in [Visayas](#) and Mindanao.^[2] Within his first decade in service,^[3] he even led [campaigns against Moro secessionist rebels](#),^[2] particularly in the provinces of [South Cotabato](#) and [Maguindanao](#), and the cities of [Zamboanga](#), General Santos, and [Davao](#) while serving as Metro District commander.^[3]

He was later assigned at the then [Criminal Investigation Service](#) of the PC (which later became the PNP).^[3] He headed the Police Anti-Crime Emergency Response and the Senior Officers Promotion Board;^[5] and served as well—as the police agency's deputy chief for administration.^[3] Also, he was the director for [Central Luzon](#),^[6] [Southern Tagalog](#), and [Laguna](#); as well as head of the Directorate for Comptrollership, and deputy of the Directorate for Investigative and Detective Management.^[3]

Prior to becoming the PNP chief, he received 41 recognitions from the military and the police,^[3] including 18 awards and nine [Military Merit Medals](#).^[2] Among them were a [Bronze Cross](#) for leading the 1985 [rescue](#) operation against a kidnap group in [Cebu City](#);^{[2][3]} and the PNP Senior Officer of the Year Award (1992).^[3] Meanwhile, he was also involved in the arrest of former legislator [Dennis Roldan](#), who had been accused of [kidnapping](#).^[3]

As PNP Chief

In July 2006, Calderon, then police Deputy Director General, became the [PNP chief](#), replacing Director General [Arturo Lomibao](#).^[3] He was appointed over contenders such as: Deputy Director Generals, Servando Hizon, PNP comptroller; and [Avelino Razon](#), PNP deputy chief for operations (his future successor).^{[1][7]}

In his first month in office, on August 1, [President](#) Arroyo imposed a ten-week deadline for the solution of high-profile killings of political activists and [journalists](#) during her term, particularly at least ten of them; as well as the arrest of suspects.^[8] The [Department of Justice](#) (DOJ) and the PNP were instructed for the special investigation, which was headed by *Task Force Usig* and whose deadline was on October 7 but only produced little progress as only few cases were filed.^[9] By the second week, Calderon claimed solving two of them.^[2]

As BuCor chief

Almost three months after his retirement from police service, on December 27, 2007, Calderon formally assumed the directorship of the [Bureau of Corrections](#),^[10] a day after being appointed by the President to replace Ricardo Dapat following the reported unauthorized trip of another former legislator and [rape](#) convict [Romeo Jalosjos](#).^[11] It was during his term that Jalosjos was only freed from the [New Bilibid Prison](#) in [Muntinlupa](#) in 2009.^[12]

Calderon was replaced by newly-installed President [Benigno Aquino III](#) (Arroyo's successor) in October 2010.^[13] In 2011, following the reported unauthorized trip of another former politician and [homicide](#) convict [Antonio Leviste](#), DOJ investigators implicated Calderon for alleged special treatment to Leviste, during his term.^[14] He was also implicated by a newspaper source in the same case of [murder](#) convict [Rolito Go](#).^[15]